

MAJOR CONTROVERSIES

The Olympic Games, which had its inception in 1896, has been witness to a wide range of **historic events** throughout the years, some great and some not very. As much as one celebrates the showpiece event for its greatness and glory, it has had its fair share of controversies and scandals. With Paris 2024 lurking on the horizon, we take a look at some of the most controversial moments in Olympics history.

Team Sportstar

WYNDHAM HALSWELLE GETS A WALKOVER

In the 1908 Summer Olympics held in London, the men's 400 metres witnessed USA's John Carpenter, who was the winner, getting disqualified. Carpenter blocked Wyndham Halswelle of Great Britain using his elbow that

was then legal under American rules but prohibited by the British rules under which the race was run.

A second final race was held due to the disqualification saga, in which Halswelle was to face the other two finalists William Robbins and John Taylor of the USA.

Both Robbins and Taylor decided to forfeit the race as a sign of protest against the judge's decision. Halswelle was thus the only medallist in the 400 metres, a controversial race which became the only ever walkover victory in Olympic history.

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1908

